

Poland: Right-wing split boosts Tusk's 2027 odds

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【メール原文】

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Poland

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Division on the right positions Tusk for likely 2027 victory

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Short-term trajectory:

Long-term trajectory:

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Prime Minister Donald Tusk's Civic Coalition (KO) party is likely to win the autumn 2027 elections (60% probability), but forming a government will be difficult as KO's smaller coalition partners risk falling below the parliamentary threshold.

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Voter concerns about migration, support for Ukraine, and the cost of living will benefit the opposition, but the ongoing fragmentation on the right will favor Tusk.

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A right-wing win—40% odds for the main opposition Law and Justice party (PiS)—would mark a significant setback for the rule of law in Poland and put Warsaw on a collision course with Brussels.

Tusk's KO likely to win 2027 elections (60% odds), but faces coalition uncertainty. KO is leading the polls at about 32%, despite a recent two percentage-point drop. Helped by strong economic growth, KO has retained its overall lead despite domestic scandals involving some of its members. The ruling party has also weathered vetoes by President Karol Nawrocki, who is backed by the opposition and has repeatedly used his power to block Tusk's reform agenda.

Yet KO's current lead would be insufficient to govern alone. Within the existing coalition, only the New Left (Nowa Lewica) is polling above 5%. The two centrist parties, the Polish People's Party (PSL) and Poland 2050 remain below the threshold to enter parliament. If these parties run separately and fail to meet the minimal threshold, Tusk could end up without coalition partners. If the smaller parties' polling does not improve by early next year, they will likely begin negotiations with KO about forming a joint list.

PiS's continued decline benefits Tusk (40% probability of a PiS win). The main opposition Law and Justice party (PiS) has seen its polling fall to a 14-year low of around 20% and is unlikely to recover substantially. The party has failed to resolve internal disputes, culminating in a July split when former prime minister Mateusz Morawiecki left the party along with 40 members of parliament, further eroding its support base.

Morawiecki's new party will likely challenge the long-standing KO-PiS duopoly. Development Plus (Rozwoj Plus) will become the third-largest caucus in the Sejm, and the party is already polling at about 6%. But for now, Morawiecki faces a long road and must build the party and define its policy direction. He will likely adopt a center-right platform focused on economic development but likely advocate for more social spending and raise taxes. Coalition options will depend on the party's policy orientation and its rhetoric.

Current issue environment favors the far right, but fragmentation will limit PiS gains. Far-right parties will likely dominate on key issues such as migration, Ukraine support, and cost of living. Yet a favorable issue environment for the far right does not translate into a clear advantage for PiS. The debate over these topics is more likely to intensify competition within the right than translate directly into support for PiS. Tusk has also shown that he can adapt his rhetoric to shifting voter priorities. Moreover, amid heightened uncertainty and Russian hybrid threats, voters may continue to value Tusk as a source of stability.

A broad right-wing coalition could win a majority but is unlikely to emerge. Previously fringe right-wing parties are growing in popularity. Antiestablishment opposition groups Confederation (Konfederacja) and Confederation of the Polish Crown (KKP) are gaining traction and together poll above 20%, threatening PiS's long-standing dominance on the right.

Both parties are euroskeptic, anti-Ukraine, and anti-migration, but KKP is more traditionalist than the economically libertarian Confederation. KKP's Grzegorz Braun is openly pro-Russia and advocates for Poland's exit from the EU. In six years, Braun's support has grown from 0.17% in the 2019 parliamentary elections to 6.34% in the 2025 presidential election, helping turn KKP from a fringe movement into a party now polling at about 10%.

If the opposition bloc unites, including PiS, Development Plus, and the antiestablishment parties, a broad right-wing coalition could attract more than 50% of the total vote. However, such an alliance remains unlikely. Policy differences and long-standing divisions will keep the opposition fragmented. Moreover, PiS will likely focus on improving its polling numbers and preserving its dominant position on the right. That effort will create further tensions with both Morawiecki and the antiestablishment parties.

Still, if PiS's standing in the polls does not improve significantly by early spring 2027, the party will likely open talks to form an alliance with other right-wing parties. Campaigning will start next spring, but the informal race has already begun. The elections will be held during the autumn, by 11 November at the latest. Signposts to watch include polling numbers, party leadership changes, unofficial and official talks about forming joint lists and future coalitions, Morawiecki's policy direction, and Tusk's policy agenda.

Right-wing win would be a significant setback for the rule of law and relations with Brussels. The policy implications would depend largely on the distribution of power within the winning coalition. But the broad direction would be clear: A government including the far right would adopt a harder line on migration, curtail the rights of Ukrainian refugees in Poland, and resist continued support for Ukraine as well as the EU's Green Deal agenda.

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